After Akbar's return to Agra in 1562, he set about rapidly consolidating the empire. From the time of the conquest of Malwa, and for the following decade, Akbar expanded the size of his dominions at a blistering pace, driven by a fierce will and a conviction that if he did not subdue his neighbours, they would rise up against him. Akbar sent Mirza Sharafuddin Hussain to subdue the province of Merta and Abdullah Khan Uzbek was appointed to bring the province of Malwa under control where Baz Bahadur was once again stirring up trouble. Baz Bahadur was expelled once again and he remained in exile at the courts of various princes till he eventually submitted eight years later and was given an honourable mansab of 1,000.

Meanwhile, at Agra, the Mughal court was effervescent with the excitement of hosting a highly eminent guest. Sayyid Beg, the ambassador of Shah Tahmasp of Persia himself, had arrived to meet with the young Mughal Padshah and elaborate arrangements were made for him. A large royal tent was set up in the Padshah's garden and the noblemen had also added their own tents, all suitably decorated. The townsfolk would go every day to the fort to amuse themselves by gawking at the visitors and admiring the decorations. Rafiuddin Shirazi, the Persian merchant, too decided to try and see the Padshah and he was standing in a tent with a crowd of spectators when all of a sudden loud shouts of 'Badshah Salaamat!' rang out. The Padshah had arrived, clearly, 'but however much left and right I looked, I did not see anyone who by appearance gave any signs or marks of royalty' wrote the puzzled Shirazi. 'When I looked behind,' he added, 'I saw that a youth of twenty years was leaning on a favourite, with his hand resting on the other's shoulder.' This nonchalant youth, Shirazi realized, was the emperor of Hindustan but he was astonished to see that no one prostrated themselves or gave the Padshah any special treatment whatsoever. Shirazi, taken aback, asked the crowds whether this casualness was normal in Hindustani courts to which he was told, 'the etiquette for courtiers and salutations at this Court is much more elaborate than those of other rulers: but the King himself is more informal. Often he comes out in ordinary dress and mixes with his confidants and makes no distinction between companions and strangers.' Shirazi ruminated over this strange explanation but agreed that he had himself seen Akbar flying a kite on the roof of his palace at Agra. On that occasion, he noted that 'his head was bare and he was wearing a lungi. From this I was convinced that His Majesty was of an open bent of mind and extremely informal.' A later Jesuit